

can easily drag and drop files using the Windows Explorer.

Shuttering with speed

The faster the shutter speed, the crisper the picture. Shutter speed is nothing but the time for which the shutter will stay open to allow light to pass and hit the CCD. The shutter speed is denoted in fractions, so the higher the denominator number, the faster the shutter speed. The shutter speed is directly proportional to the depth of field, the subject and the area behind.

The faster the shutter speed, the lesser the depth of field and, hence, most amateur photographers use slow shutter speed to get the best depth of field. Besides, faster shutter speed also demands lots of hand stability because if your hand moves even a little bit, the image will be blurry. Therefore, it is better to first test how fast the camera shoots. If it takes more than six seconds before you can shoot again, then the camera is probably not worth your time.



The conventional Kodak with a digi-cam

Storing the images

If you are conscious about the image quality, then save your files in either a .bmp or .tif format. These formats do not compress the image or lose detail. Of course, a whole lot also depends on the storage space your device has. For instance, an image at 1600x1200 pixels in an uncompressed format can easily take up 2-3 MB and with an 8 MB storage, you will only get four images

before you have to transfer it to the computer. So, make the right choice between your compression and storage.

Enhancing Quality

Here are a few tips for better quality photographs with digital cameras

Getting the basics right

Working with a digital camera is quite similar to working with a normal camera, and a little knowledge of photography will always hold you in good stead. A few tips on capturing a good image are worth the while.

Try and capture a moment of spontaneity instead of a dull pose. However, don't go in for complex scenes or settings; try and keep the setting as simple and natural as possible and try to avoid backgrounds with lots of action as they take away from the focus. You should try to be as close to the focussed subject as possible, as this will eliminate a whole lot of the background action and will also add a more intimate touch. Also, remember that the flash is not just for images taken in the dark or with low light. You can even use it in normal circumstances for better colour reproduction or reducing the shadows in outdoor lights.

And lastly, try to always carry your digital camera around with you. You shouldn't be wanting when the glorious moment to capture your photograph for life comes by.

Clicking off-centre

All of us are mostly used to clicking with the main person or object in focus or in the centre of the viewfinder. This creates empty space around the focussed object, and takes a bit away from the quality of the photograph. A better method is to click with the focused object a little bit to the left or right in a manner such that it fills up the entire viewfinder.

This makes for a more visually appealing photograph. This is where the LCD screen in a digital camera comes in handy. You can easily get a real-time preview of the image on the LCD before you

click the photograph.

Focus on the neutral area

Always keep in mind while taking a snap that you don't focus on the very bright or very dark area. Instead, you will get much better results if you focus on the neutral area where the lighting condition is not extreme.

Setting the white balance

There are basically four white balance modes that come in a digital camera. These modes are daylight, cloudy, tungsten and fluorescent. Daylight is used



Printers to digital cameras the Fuji way

mostly for outdoor photography, whereas tungsten is used for indoor photography and fluorescent is for taking images in which the target is of fluorescent colour. If you are taking a photograph of, say, some castle with the bright sky as the background, then keep the rest of the settings, such as white balance, to auto and increase the exposure by one point. In the image, the castle will retain all the detail that you would have wanted and the sky will also look a little brighter. This enhances the quality of the image.

Using the Macro mode

While taking a close-up photograph, always turn on the Macro mode. This is the minimum range from which the camera can take photographs of the target. If Macro mode is enabled, then it is possible to take the photograph from as near as 0.1 metre, else it is most likely that at such close distance the image will get blurred.

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